

What sweeter music

*Words by
Robert Herrick
(1591-1674)

for Stephen Cleobury and
the choir of King's College, Cambridge

JOHN RUTTER

Andante tranquillo (♩ = 66) **SOPRANOS** *p dolce e legato*

What sweet-er

ORGAN Sw. *p legato sempre* Man.

5 mu - sic can we bring Than a ca - rol, for to sing The birth of

9 *mp* this our heav'n-ly King? *mf* A-wake the voice! *mp unis.* A-wake the string! Dark and dull

13 *poco meno mosso* night, fly hence a - way, T. B. And give the ho - nour to this day That sees De -

17 *pp poco rit.* *a tempo* (♩ = 66) S. A. -cem - ber turn'd to May, That sees De - cem - ber turn'd to May. Why does the
T. B. *dim.* *p* *pp* *mp cantabile*

21 *unis.* chill - ing win-ter's morn Smile, like a field be - set with corn? Or smell like a

25 *mf* *f dolce* *mp* 2

mea-dow new-ly shorn Thus on the sud - den? Come and see The cause, why

29 S. 1 *mp* *mf* S. 2 A. *mp* *mf*

'Tis he is born, whose quick-'ning birth Gives life and

things thus fra-grant be: 'Tis he is born, whose quick-'ning birth Gives life and

33 S. *mp* *p molto legato* A. *mp* *p molto legato*

lu - stre, pub-lic mirth, To hea-ven and the un-der- earth. We see him

lu - stre, pub-lic mirth, To hea-ven and the un-der- earth. *p molto legato*

37 S. A. T. B. Turns all the

come, and know him ours, — Who, with his sun-shine and his show'rs, Turns the

41 *mp* *mf* *p*

pa - tient ground to flow'rs, turns all the pa - tient ground to flow'rs. The

mp *mp* *mf* *pp*

turns all the ground to — flow'rs. The

45 S. div. *pp*

dar-ling of the world is come, And fit it is, we find a room To —

dar - ling of the world is come, we — find — a

49

wel-come him, to wel-come him. The no-bler part of all the house here, is the
room to wel-come him. *mp* *cresc.*

53

heart, Which we will give him; and be-queath This hol-ly, and this
mf *mp*

57

i - vy wreath, And Lord of
i - vy wreath, To do him ho - nour; who's our King, And Lord of
i - vy wreath, To do him ho - nour; who's our King, And Lord of

60

poco f *mf* *p* *pp molto dolce*
all this re - vel - ling. What sweet - er
poco f *mf* *p* *pp molto dolce*
all this re - vel - ling. What sweet - er
poco f *mf* *p* *pp molto dolce*
all this re - vel - ling. What sweet - er

64

mu - sic can we bring Than_ a ca - rol, for to

67

mp *poco rit.* *p* *poco meno mosso*

S. sing The birth_ of this our heav'n- ly King, the birth of

A. sing The birth of this our heav'n- ly King. (*Hum*)

T. sing The birth_ of this our heav'n- ly King. (*Hum*)

B. sing The birth of this our heav'n- ly King. (*Hum*)

70

dim. *rit.* *a tempo* *pp*

this our hea - ven - ly King.